

0:0:0.0 --> 0:0:1.530

INTERVIEWER - MW

Yeah, it's all set.

0:0:2.350 --> 0:0:6.40

INTERVIEWER - MW

So the first question I have for you is.

0:0:6.790 --> 0:0:9.170

INTERVIEWER - MW

What does occupational stress mean to you?

0:0:11.470 --> 0:0:13.300

FR06

Uh stress that's induced.

0:0:14.670 --> 0:0:16.250

FR06

Due to my job.

0:0:20.100 --> 0:0:25.520

INTERVIEWER - MW

And what does that look like typically? How has that looked over the past several years?

0:0:27.940 --> 0:0:29.240

FR06

Sleepless nights.

0:0:29.930 --> 0:0:32.40

FR06

Headaches and insomnia.

0:0:32.680 --> 0:0:33.930

FR06

Anxiety.

0:0:35.180 --> 0:0:45.500

FR06

Uh. Frustration, anger, anger towards my family. They don't understand why I can't do things a day after I come home from work, even though I may have slept all night. You don't really sleep.

0:0:47.20 --> 0:0:47.720

FR06

Things like that.

0:0:49.210 --> 0:0:49.620

INTERVIEWER - MW

Gotcha.

0:0:51.580 --> 0:0:57.360

INTERVIEWER - MW

In what forms does that stress come at you at work to lead to this thing?

0:1:0.140 --> 0:1:2.140

FR06

Like what triggers the stress or?

0:1:1.970 --> 0:1:2.960

INTERVIEWER - MW

Hmm yeah.

0:1:6.370 --> 0:1:12.170

FR06

OK, lot lots of things. So we have a very big busy schedule, [LOCATION].

0:1:12.910 --> 0:1:20.970

FR06

[OUR DEPARTMENT] is a prominent department. We live in a high tax bracket, so we're expected to do a lot of things aside from just taking runs.

0:1:22.630 --> 0:1:30.300

FR06

So we have chores throughout the day and then we try to train throughout the day so we get bounced around and get told to go things last minute.

0:1:31.0 --> 0:1:40.390

FR06

Which, if you've ever talk to a fireman, we are creatures of habit and we don't like change. But we deal with change all day long, so it's very.

0:1:41.610 --> 0:1:46.10

FR06

Interesting dynamic and then just depends on the call I'm gonna run on.

0:1:46.770 --> 0:1:53.400

FR06

If I if fires are kind of straightforward, that's kind of get the job done, but God forbid we trying to victim.

0:1:54.110 --> 0:2:2.980

FR06

That'll that'll mess with your mind for a while. EMS calls mess with your mind for a while. A cardiac arrest I particularly.

0:2:3.740 --> 0:2:8.850

FR06

Am in the process of being subpoenaed for a murder trial that I walked in on.

0:2:9.490 --> 0:2:12.550

FR06

And my scene wasn't safe when I arrived on the scene. So.

0:2:13.690 --> 0:2:28.520

FR06

I I am being challenged with that right now personally because now I have to, like, relive the scene all over again in order to testify here in a couple weeks and just even driving by that House on other calls or going past that street.

0:2:29.150 --> 0:2:31.880

FR06

It it makes it a little uneasy every day.

0:2:33.540 --> 0:2:34.670

INTERVIEWER - MW

Oh wow, yeah.

0:2:35.590 --> 0:2:42.880

INTERVIEWER - MW

Imagine that kind of at least a question we have here, like describe a scenario where you felt overwhelmed during the job.

0:2:44.450 --> 0:2:49.30

FR06

Yeah. So, so that day absolutely like is.

0:2:49.960 --> 0:2:51.540

FR06

Burned into my mind.

0:2:52.780 --> 0:2:57.630

FR06

2 o'clock in the morning rolled up our house is completely dark. Got called for CPR in progress.

0:2:58.960 --> 0:3:16.540

FR06

It was a little uneasy. It wasn't the normal like family members are running at you. We need help. We need help because, I mean, that's the normal case and it's like, OK. Yep, we're coming. It's gonna be alright. So I mean, we've learned to manage that. I've learned to manage family members that are in distress.

0:3:17.170 --> 0:3:29.380

FR06

But this one was very calm. The these family members are very calm and then house is dark welcomed into the house, told to go down the the hall to the right, you know and.

0:3:30.100 --> 0:3:31.290

FR06

The police wasn't on the scene.

0:3:32.480 --> 0:3:34.520

FR06

I get to work with my partner and.

0:3:35.340 --> 0:3:41.890

FR06

I'm hearing noises in the background. Police is saying I need to see your hands and when you hear those words.

0:3:42.580 --> 0:3:51.450

FR06

From an officer, I'm like, what? What? Wait a minute. Why? Why do we need to? Why do we need to see this gentleman's hands up in the air? That kind of thing. And.

0:3:52.560 --> 0:3:57.170

FR06

So with fire, we're always told the to hold back on certain calls.

0:3:57.960 --> 0:4:5.330

FR06

Let the scene be swept by the officers. Make sure there's no threats to ourselves, because if someone's gonna do harm, sometimes they don't see.

0:4:6.290 --> 0:4:20.190

FR06

They just see somebody in a uniform not saying that I I wish harm upon any officer. You know what I mean? But as fire firefighters, medics I, I'm not looking to be. I'm. I'm here to help. I'm not here to apprehend you in any sort of way. That kind of thing. So.

0:4:21.620 --> 0:4:24.380

FR06

Yeah, that that call definitely burns my mind.

0:4:28.90 --> 0:4:37.20

INTERVIEWER - MW

Well, how do you like? Where do you go and to to start processing that and just continue to be high functioning?

0:4:39.950 --> 0:4:46.180

FR06

So we do a debrief that call definitely got on the scene debrief as soon as everything was.

0:4:46.880 --> 0:4:48.340

FR06

Situated taking care of.

0:4:49.100 --> 0:4:49.960

FR06

Mitigated.

0:4:51.810 --> 0:4:59.150

FR06

We usually do them on the tail board of the medic. If we're not gonna transport a patient, that patient did not get transported on the scene for these stayed there.

0:5:0.70 --> 0:5:8.150

FR06

If it doesn't get down there in the medics, then it gets done back at the station, but I'll tell you I've been on many calls, not just that one where.

0:5:8.870 --> 0:5:17.150

FR06

The the run is over and I gotta go restock my truck and then I get another run. I may not debrief until later that evening at the dinner table.

0:5:18.530 --> 0:5:21.360

FR06

If the day is busy enough, I may not debrief at all.

0:5:22.650 --> 0:5:28.110

FR06

And there's been sometimes where they've brought our department chaplain in and talked to us, they've.

0:5:29.410 --> 0:5:34.470

FR06

Different senior guys will reach out to you that have had different experiences.

0:5:36.310 --> 0:5:48.780

FR06

It all varies, but to be honest, like 99% of the time on any call that that is stressful, you just bury it down for a while and you move on to the next one because you you got to go and do your job, still.

0:5:50.190 --> 0:5:50.720

INTERVIEWER - MW

Yeah.

0:5:52.310 --> 0:5:56.960

INTERVIEWER - MW

Man So what would be helpful for you for stress reduction while on the job?

0:6:0.790 --> 0:6:2.60

FR06

Well on the job.

0:6:3.390 --> 0:6:15.390

FR06

Well, I would say, you know, I know it's not gonna happen instantly, like within minutes of a call happening. But at the station to have resources or additional education on how to.

0:6:16.500 --> 0:6:22.130

FR06

Like mind meditation [MENTIONS ANOTHER EMERGENCY JOB CONTEXT].

0:6:22.770 --> 0:6:24.370

FR06

Many classes on how to.

0:6:25.290 --> 0:6:38.220

FR06

How breathing controlling your breathing visual meditation can help you in a stressful situation. Now I try to use it at the fire service, but the culture in the fire service does not.

0:6:39.770 --> 0:6:45.40

FR06

Support that cause you know, just as the public may seem, we've been.

0:6:46.160 --> 0:6:47.210

FR06

Taught to.

0:6:49.10 --> 0:6:56.330

FR06

Put on a good face you strong, especially in a man's world. So now I'm a female stepping into a man's job, and I've got to do the same thing.

0:6:56.930 --> 0:7:10.280

FR06

Because, yeah, you don't wanna show weakness. Because if you show weakness, the policies weakness and then you can't do your job affectively. So it'd be nice to to kind of hopefully breakthrough the stigma that it's OK to not be OK and it's OK to say so on the job.

0:7:12.530 --> 0:7:13.400

INTERVIEWER - MW

Yeah, that's good.

0:7:14.980 --> 0:7:20.70

INTERVIEWER - MW

Do you what if any, types of chronic work related pain do you have that a thing for you?

0:7:22.30 --> 0:7:28.820

FR06

I pain is subjective but never had headaches before. I had headaches.

0:7:29.590 --> 0:7:32.400

FR06

Some days I go to sleep with a headache, wake up with a headache. Just.

0:7:34.190 --> 0:7:43.860

FR06

You know, and then ailments from the job that it's, it's hard work here. I put about 115 pounds on my back. If I'm on the fire truck.

0:7:44.560 --> 0:7:54.50

FR06

Depending on the type of call and I mean I'm only [MENTIONS HER HEIGHT AND WEIGHT] so my joints take a beating, but we got good PT and we got.

0:7:54.710 --> 0:8:0.370

FR06

A trainer that comes by. So it's just a matter of doing the doing the work to prepare for the hard stuff.

0:8:2.150 --> 0:8:2.590

INTERVIEWER - MW

Absolutely.

0:8:3.240 --> 0:8:8.810

INTERVIEWER - MW

What opportunities do you see for incorporating well-being resources into your daily workflow?

0:8:10.970 --> 0:8:35.420

FR06

A huge opportunity that but with only one hurdle to overcome and that's the administration. So the higher up's, the ones that aren't on the street anymore, they don't see how jam packed our day is and there's only 24 hours in a day and there's only so many hours of daylight. So to find an hour of time.

0:8:36.550 --> 0:8:43.140

FR06

Per shift or even once a week when you're on the job to to be able to sit down and decompress. It's gonna be hard to.

0:8:43.790 --> 0:8:46.20

FR06

To get past the the chief.

0:8:46.620 --> 0:8:57.280

FR06

Because they they don't need that right now. They don't need that anymore. And most of the time, if you're sitting in the chief's office and you're you're wearing a white shirt, you've been off the street for a long time now. So you kind of.

0:8:58.200 --> 0:9:4.650

FR06

I would hope you haven't forgotten, but your body is mentally and physically kind of forgotten how stressful some things can be.

0:9:7.980 --> 0:9:10.580

INTERVIEWER - MW

Yeah. You mentioned some earlier when we first started about.

0:9:11.380 --> 0:9:31.440

INTERVIEWER - MW

How you're in a higher tax bracket, you're in a an area that's a higher tax bracket. Do you feel like is that is that a thing to where there's this unspoken like we have to be just busy bees because there's this expectation because we're in this district that we have to operate at a certain capacity. What is that about?

0:9:34.950 --> 0:9:43.500

FR06

Yeah. So that is a real deal that not all or very few departments struggle with.

0:9:44.210 --> 0:10:2.460

FR06

Because, I mean, I I sit up in [THIS LOCATION WHERE IF A TOURNAMENT IS UP], I've got \$1,000,000 homes that we have to preplan or be responsible for. If if an incident comes through and it is stressful, a lot of our our day is spent on public image.

0:10:24.630 --> 0:10:25.90

INTERVIEWER - MW

Umm.

0:10:3.140 --> 0:10:34.390

FR06

You know, we're we're one of few departments that the sure it's gotta be touched in a college shirt and you can't show tattoos hairs above the collar. You got to look clean cut all the time. The trucks got to be polished and and that takes a lot like I'm not saying you know I'd rather look sloppy because I wouldn't I carry a lot of pride in the way that I look whether I'm at work or not but it's just an added stress I mean our station has to look pristine at any time because of the citizen of the public can come in.

0:10:34.720 --> 0:10:52.660

FR06

And you know, we're also trying to show transparency and yeah, come on in. See the station. It looks great. No, it doesn't matter what hour you know. And sometimes that expectation is is a lot, and then it comes with some other things, like on an EMS run.

0:10:53.800 --> 0:10:57.10

FR06

Everybody's emergency is an emergency to themselves.

0:10:57.620 --> 0:11:4.890

FR06

But when you bring in someone who's a professional and you're telling me, you know, I think I need to go to the ER for a hangnail.

0:11:5.660 --> 0:11:36.310

FR06

And it's very difficult for me to explain to somebody I hate to use the word privilege because it happens on both spectrums of like the really rich and the really poor that just think like, well, like this is I need to go to the ER for this and it's hard to explain to somebody who say like, I understand that this is hard for you right now and that's OK. But I do not want to bomb down the ER for someone who really needs it and like to say that then someone jumps on your face like, well, you don't think I really need this. Like you don't you don't care.

0:11:37.0 --> 0:11:50.460

FR06

So then it's a whole different battle. So sometimes you see it with even senior guys too, that they'll just be like, Yep, alright, get in like, let. Let's go. Yep. Not a problem. We'll take you down. Well, OK. Well, then you're putting.

0:11:51.170 --> 0:11:58.730

FR06

More stress on the emergency room, more stress on the city because our city is always high. I mean, shoot the the ER's are overflowing all the time.

0:12:0.20 --> 0:12:9.120

FR06

And so then, like, yeah, I'm trying to keep a good relationship with my nursing staff, and I'm bringing patients to. And they're like, what the heck? And I'm like, I'm stuck here.

0:12:10.920 --> 0:12:14.190

INTERVIEWER - MW

All right. It looking at you like you're one of us. Well, you know better than this.

0:12:14.700 --> 0:12:15.480

FR06

Yeah.

0:12:16.550 --> 0:12:26.780

INTERVIEWER - MW

And now that's that's, that's insightful. This is like there's some systematic level type things here that always at play.

0:12:27.810 --> 0:12:28.250

FR06

Ohh yeah.

0:12:27.870 --> 0:12:34.160

INTERVIEWER - MW

So what are? What are your thoughts regarding the incorporation of mindfulness practice into your daily work life?

0:12:36.940 --> 0:12:37.950

FR06

I'm I'm for it.

0:12:38.730 --> 0:12:42.780

FR06

I'll I'll give 110% just like it do any other thing that comes with the job.

0:12:43.430 --> 0:12:58.300

FR06

It would definitely it definitely be helpful because I know myself included. I'm I'm still new. I mean I've only been on the job for 2 1/2 years, but I also come with my own baggage just like anybody else does. I mean, I've been a nurse in the ER for seven years now.

0:12:59.30 --> 0:13:7.690

FR06

And being mindful on the job and having some way to decompress is is very helpful because I know a lot of the guys are going to.

0:13:8.460 --> 0:13:12.590

FR06

Therapy outside, outside of work, they're taking their own time and then.

0:13:13.310 --> 0:13:16.990

FR06

It that creates its own stress cause half the time we're switching insurance.

0:13:17.750 --> 0:13:27.440

FR06

People every year and one year. You're your counseling that you've been working with covered the next year, they're not, and then you're like, whoa, I can't just go reestablish this.

0:13:28.60 --> 0:13:44.110

FR06

Whole framework that I've set up this relationship I've set up with this counselor and then like get rid of it and start fresh somewhere else. So then they start paying out of pocket. Well that that's even more stress. Cause now I'm I'm paying for a service I should have had, but I don't have it. It's it's a circle.

0:13:47.70 --> 0:13:51.490

INTERVIEWER - MW

Yeah. What are your thoughts regarding the use of like a stress reduction app during work?

0:13:54.190 --> 0:13:55.140

FR06

Um.

0:13:57.870 --> 0:13:58.230

FR06

Umm.

0:13:59.890 --> 0:14:0.980

FR06

It could be helpful.

0:14:3.20 --> 0:14:3.840

FR06

I don't know.

0:14:5.170 --> 0:14:7.980

FR06

How receptive that would be?

0:14:8.680 --> 0:14:10.130

FR06

Because we are always.

0:14:11.50 --> 0:14:15.700

FR06

Looking at a computer looking at our phones for calls, runs, whatever.

0:14:16.470 --> 0:14:16.870

INTERVIEWER - MW

Yeah.

0:14:16.810 --> 0:14:23.170

FR06

I run other parts of the the department. [MENTIONS UNION ROLE]

0:14:24.330 --> 0:14:46.780

FR06

And I've been trying to incorporate that, it's 2022 and we should be using our phones and QR codes and all that stuff and it's still an old senior guy department. They don't like that. They don't like it. They like to look at paper, they like to flip their book. You know what I mean? Like they like to do it the old school way. And I get it in the young guys want to do it the new school way. But there's not enough of them to get a buy in.

0:14:47.970 --> 0:14:49.560

INTERVIEWER - MW

Gotcha. Yeah. No, that's.

0:14:51.390 --> 0:14:57.460

INTERVIEWER - MW

That's good to hear. Any other barriers do you think that would be for using the stress reduction app during the work day?

0:15:0.530 --> 0:15:3.960

FR06

No, I mean time constraints, but if that's something you can't change.

0:15:4.900 --> 0:15:5.210

INTERVIEWER - MW

Yeah.

0:15:7.170 --> 0:15:9.890

INTERVIEWER - MW

So what information would be important to include in the app?

0:15:13.660 --> 0:15:15.200

FR06

In the in like the app.

0:15:15.670 --> 0:15:16.150

INTERVIEWER - MW

Mm-hmm.

0:15:17.520 --> 0:15:17.770

FR06

Hmm.

0:15:18.470 --> 0:15:20.660

INTERVIEWER - MW

Blank canvas where? Where do you think we should start?

0:15:22.510 --> 0:15:26.670

FR06

That that absolutely the breathwork just controlling your breathing.

0:15:27.980 --> 0:15:28.340

FR06

Uh.

0:15:30.110 --> 0:15:34.280

FR06

That is super helpful I find for new and old people.

0:15:35.220 --> 0:15:36.80

FR06

And then.

0:15:39.600 --> 0:15:40.100

FR06

Yeah.

0:15:41.40 --> 0:15:44.100

FR06

It probably the terminology that you put in there.

0:15:45.230 --> 0:16:5.150

FR06

Because we are now being introduced to to yoga and it is a, it's an uphill battle because, I mean, you gotta a bunch of guys that are aging from 45 to 58 and they're like yoga, I'm not doing that. You know what I mean? So it's all about the words and the way that you present it.

0:16:6.140 --> 0:16:7.490

FR06

I think if it's put in.

0:16:8.800 --> 0:16:16.300

FR06

Simpler, maybe something that doesn't seem they just seem so weak. Cannot say that we're weak. They may have a buy in.

0:16:18.680 --> 0:16:19.540

INTERVIEWER - MW

Good to know.

0:16:20.630 --> 0:16:31.730

INTERVIEWER - MW

If we were going to have sort of thing about having like video, there'd be a constructional videos in the app and we're just curious who you who you think should be present in those videos. If you're able to watch them on the app.

0:16:33.540 --> 0:16:36.600

FR06

Ohh I I bet you get a vast.

0:16:38.260 --> 0:16:51.780

FR06

Spectrum of of guys watching it for sure, videos are a little easier, cause yeah, if you're doing videos you can do it in your private time. They don't have to read something that sometimes they can listen to it and be doing something else.

0:16:53.250 --> 0:16:54.390

FR06

The videos would be nice.

0:16:56.460 --> 0:17:2.770

INTERVIEWER - MW

Do you think who was in the video would contribute to the buy in at all depending on like who the actual instructor is?

0:17:3.680 --> 0:17:14.700

FR06

Yeah, yeah, yeah. If you've got somebody that knows is a first responder, is married, or works directly with the first responder, someone who can relate to being on the street.

0:17:15.590 --> 0:17:34.120

FR06

Uh would would be huge because we do a lot of training with individuals who have no idea what what it's like to be woken up, you know, at 2:00 o'clock in the morning and not know what we're going to. So I would definitely say somebody who who's?

0:17:35.360 --> 0:17:40.130

FR06

Who knows, the service, even military individuals. They get it, they get it.

0:17:45.300 --> 0:17:45.760

INTERVIEWER - MW

Well.

0:17:46.790 --> 0:17:50.570

INTERVIEWER - MW

See that was painless. We made it through all of our questions in the.

0:17:50.340 --> 0:17:50.660

FR06

Cool.

0:17:52.0 --> 0:17:59.60

INTERVIEWER - MW

Anything else that you want us to know or think would be helpful as we're looking to design or work based stress reduction program.

0:18:1.490 --> 0:18:4.640

FR06

Not that I can think of off the off the top of my head, you know.

0:18:5.620 --> 0:18:6.40

INTERVIEWER - MW

Yeah.

0:18:7.130 --> 0:18:13.760

INTERVIEWER - MW

OK. I mean, this was great. It's it's always, you know, as many times as we do this like everyone shares a unique.

0:18:14.510 --> 0:18:16.760

INTERVIEWER - MW

Inside or angle of how they perceive stress?

0:18:19.830 --> 0:18:20.120

FR06

OK.

0:18:21.770 --> 0:18:22.260

FR06

Sure.